

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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I WILL NOT GO OUT FREE - Exodus 21:5

Our text

Exodus 21:1-6

*1 Now these are the judgments which thou shalt set before them. 2 If thou buy an Hebrew servant, six years he shall serve: and in the seventh he shall go out free for nothing. 3 If he came in by himself, he shall go out by himself: if he were married, then his wife shall go out with him. 4 If his master have given him a wife, and she have born him sons or daughters; the wife and her children shall be her master's, and he shall go out by himself. 5 And if the servant shall plainly say, I love my master, my wife, and my children; **I will not go out free**. 6 Then his master shall bring him unto the judges; he shall also bring him to the door, or unto the door post; and his master shall bore his ear through with an aul; and he shall serve him forever. KJV*

OUR MESSAGE – LOVE'S CHOICE TO BE BOND-SLAVE FOREVER

LOVES EXPRESSION FOR

This story is about a bond slave's love for his master, his wife and his children and BECAUSE OF THAT LOVE freely of his own volition CHOOSES not to accept his freedom FROM continued SERVICE and publicly declares "**I will not go out free**"; accepting the mark OF A BOND-SERVANT in his own body as evidence that he will serve his master for the rest of his life (forever) BONDING HIMSELF IN SERVICE AS A LOVE-SLAVE TO HIS MASTER.

I WILL NOT GO OUT FREE - A BONDED SERVANT'S CHOICE

Exodus 21:5

THIS BONDED SERVANT'S LOVE COMPELLED HIM **NOT TO GO OUT FREE** FROM SERVING HIS MASTER.

THIS IS AN EXAMPLE OF TRUE LOVE THAT FREELY AND UNEQUIVOCALLY CHOOSES TO COMMIT TO SERVING GOD BEFORE ALL ELSE.

A LOVE THAT EXPRESSES ITSELF IN CHOOSING SERVITUDE / SLAVERY RATHER THAN PERSONAL FREEDOMS

SUCH A CHOICE MEANS THAT THERE CANNOT BE ANY WAVERING, VACILLATING QUESTIONING OR TURNING BACK.

THIS KIND OF LOVE'S DEVOTION IS NOT ONLY REFLECTED IN THIS BONDED SERVANT BUT ALSO IN

1. Christ's love to serve his father in the purpose for which he was sent into the world. Where Christ willingly chose to go to his suffering on the cross and would not go out free.
2. And also, the example set for every believer that out of love for Christ they also willingly choose to serve Christ for the entirety of their lives (forever) thus expressing loves determination **not to go out free** – not choosing other personal pathways that the Tempter presents.

CHRIST WILLINGLY WENT TO HIS SUFFERING ON THE CROSS, CHOOSING NOT TO GO OUT FREE.

Setting a specific example for every believer to choose NOT TO GO OUT FREE from service to his lord but to serve his master forever.

WHAT OF PREVIOUS PROMISES WE HAVE MADE?

THINK FOR A MOMENT of the time WHEN ACCEPTING CHRIST AS SAVIOUR AND LORD PROMISES were WILLINGLY MADE TO FOLLOW AND SERVE HIM FOR ALL OF YOUR LIFE.

IS SUCH EXPRESSION OF LOVE AND DEVOTION FOR CHRIST STILL DOMINANT IN OUR LIVES TODAY WHERE WE HAVE FREELY CHOSEN TO REMAIN CHRIST'S BONDED SLAVE (bond servant) AND **NOT GO OUT FREE** FROM SERVING OUR MASTER AND LORD FOREVER.

In the book of Galatians 1:10 - it defines the believer as a Bondservant or slave of Christ

Galatians 1:10 For do I now persuade men, or God? Or do I seek to please men? For if I still pleased men, I would not be a **bondservant of Christ**. NKJV

Galatians 1:10 Am I now trying to gain the approval of people, or of God? Or am I trying to please people? If I were still trying to please people, I would not be a slave of Christ! NET

A Bond slave

In the Bible, a bond slave is someone who has been given their freedom but voluntarily chooses to remain in a state of servitude, typically **out of love and gratitude for their master**.

This choice signifies a deep commitment and dedication to serving their master, going beyond mere duty or obligation.

Relationship with Christ:

The New Testament uses the term "bondservant" to describe those who are bound to Christ through their faith and love, willingly serving His purposes.

A slave

In ancient times, a person might have **become a slave** either **voluntarily** (e.g., to pay off a debt) or **involuntarily** (e.g., through birth or criminal sentencing). **Slavery** in Bible times did not necessarily carry the current associations of cruelty and dehumanization related to the nineteenth-century institution.

Possibly a more appropriate translation of Galatians 1:10 is "servant of Christ" rather than "bondservant of Christ".

Paul's unwavering dedication to winning the approval of God and not people is a testament to his faith He was devoted to serving Christ alone.

Ephesians 6:6 Do this not only when they are watching you, because you want to gain their approval; but with all your heart do what God wants, as slaves of Christ. GNT also as bondservants of Christ ESV

1 Thessalonians 2:4 For we speak as messengers from God, trusted by him to tell the truth; we change his message not one bit to suit the taste of those who hear it; for we serve God alone,..." TLB

AS BONDSERVANTS OF CHRIST, LIKE PAUL, WE ARE TO LIVE TO PLEASE GOD AND NOT PEOPLE, "DOING THE WILL OF GOD FROM THE HEART" - Ephesians 6:5-6 ESV

FREE TO CHOOSE

THE APOSTLE PAUL POSSESSED THE FREEDOM TO EITHER SERVE CHRIST OR NOT.

He chose to become **Christ's servant – his bond-slave** and **not to go out free** from serving his master for the remainder of his life.

TODAY, EVERY CHRISTIAN IS CALLED TO BE A BONDSERVANT OF JESUS CHRIST.

JESUS STEADFASTLY SET HIS FACE TO GO TO JERUSALEM

Jesus was resolutely determined to face the suffering of calvary's cross and not to go out free from it.

Luke 9:51-53

51 And it came to pass, when the time was come that he should be received up, he steadfastly set his face to go to Jerusalem,

52 And sent messengers before his face: and they went, and entered into a village of the Samaritans, to make ready for him. 53 And they did not receive him, because his face was as though he would go to Jerusalem. KJV

He steadfastly and determinedly set His face to go

Luke 9:51-53

51 And it came to pass, when the time was come that he should be received up, he steadfastly set his face to go to Jerusalem,

52 And sent messengers before his face: and they went and entered into a village of the Samaritans, to make ready for him.

53 And they did not receive him, because his face was as though he would go to Jerusalem. Webster - Also prophesied in Isaiah 50:5-7

THE "SETTING ONE'S FACE LIKE FLINT" signifies a resolute determination, unwavering commitment, and unwavering obedience to God, even in the face of adversity.

THE APOSTLE PAUL – was Bound in the spirit

Acts 20:22-24

22 And now behold, I go bound in the spirit to Jerusalem, not knowing the things that shall befall me there: 23 Save that the Holy Spirit testifieth in every city, saying, that bonds and afflictions abide me. 24 But none of these things move me, neither count I my life dear to myself, Webster Bible

Even though Paul knew that bonds and afflictions awaited him but none of these things deterred him because he was resolute in bearing witness to Christ in both Jerusalem and Rome.

He had set face to go to Jerusalem

Acts 23:11 That night the Lord appeared to Paul and said, "Be encouraged, Paul. Just as you have been a witness to me here in Jerusalem, you must preach the Good News in Rome as well." NLT

May God strengthen our resolve to continue to serve our Lord and master Christ as a love-slave, a bonded servant and remaining resolute not to go out free. Amen - Ps Barry